CLASS 9 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 1

Chapters 5–8: **Early Humans and Civilisation (History), State and Society up to 1000 CE (History), Democracy (Political Science), Elections (Political Science)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Assertion (A): Harappan trade with Mesopotamia is certain. Reason (R): Mesopotamian records mention Meluhha. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

2. Which of the following is NOT a part of saptanga? 1

(a) Priests **(b)** King **(c)** Treasury **(d)** Allies

3. A politician offers free goods in exchange for votes. This is a threat to 1

(a) free and fair choice **(b)** judicial review
(c) trade **(d)** the monsoon

4. Which statement is true of the ECI? 1

(a) Part of cabinet **(b)** Appointed by parties
(c) Autonomous and permanent **(d)** Temporary

5. A civilisation with pyramids, papyrus and pharaohs is 1

(a) Egyptian **(b)** Sumerian **(c)** Chinese **(d)** Babylonian

6. A guild of silk weavers moving across regions shows 1

(a) tribal war **(b)** no trade
(c) economic mobility **(d)** isolation

7. Assertion (A): Reservation for women in panchayats increases participation. Reason (R): It ensures seats for women. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

8. Assertion (A): ETPBS is used by service voters. Reason (R): They are posted outside their constituencies. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

9. Why did some societies shift to farming later than others? 1

(a) they disliked cooked food
(b) they had no use for tools
(c) they had already invented iron
(d) local conditions and resources differ

10. A historian finds a copper plate recording a land grant to brahmanas by a Pallava ruler. This shows 1

(a) a war
(b) a guild
(c) a trade route
(d) Brahmadeya tradition

11. Which pair is correct? 1

(a) USA - parliamentary
(b) Switzerland - presidential
(c) India - presidential
(d) Canada - parliamentary

12. Assertion (A): Parties must hold internal elections. Reason (R): ECI insists on inner-party democracy. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

13. **Assertion (A):** Mehrgarh is important for studying the origins of the Harappan civilisation. 1
Reason (R): It shows farming, herding and crafts that existed before the Harappan cities.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

14. **Assertion (A):** Magadha emerged as the strongest mahajanapada. 1
Reason (R): It had fertile plains, iron resources and strong rulers.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

15. **Assertion (A):** India is called the world's largest democracy. 1
Reason (R): India has the largest electorate of any country.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. How did the Harappans and Mesopotamians differ in writing? 2

17. Why is the Junagadh Rock a unique source? 2

18. How does judicial review protect rights? 2

19. Why is the Speaker's role crucial under anti-defection law? 2

20. Why did food production change social life? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Explain why oracle bones are historical sources. 3

22. Explain how literature shows social life of the Guptas. 3

23. Analyse the role of Parliament's Question Hour. 3

24. Assess the claim that FPTP encourages two-party competition. 3

OR

Why is the Iron Age significant? 3

25. Compare early Tamil kingdoms with Mauryan empire. 3

OR

A newspaper reports that a village built toilets after Gram Sabha discussions. Link this to democratic principles. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. **Case study.** Archaeologists excavate a site in Baluchistan. They find mud-brick houses, storage rooms, wheat and barley grains, polished stone tools, and a few copper objects. They conclude that people here were farming and rearing animals long before cities appeared. 5

(i) Name this oldest known farming village of the subcontinent.
(ii) Which age is known for polished tools and farming?
(iii) What does the use of both copper and stone indicate?
(iv) Why is the shift from hunting to farming called a revolution?

27. Critically examine how far India has realised democratic values since 1950. 5

OR

Discuss why elections alone do not guarantee democracy. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 50 Marks

MASTERMIND